

The Saturation Theorem: Axiomatic Constraints on Quantum Gravity from Cosmological Relaxation

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We formulate four minimal axioms – finite geometric capacity, cooperative reinforcement, monotone cosmic control, and renormalization-group composition – as candidate macroscopic constraints for any quantum gravity theory whose cosmological limit reproduces general relativity with a bounded relaxation mechanism. These axioms imply an Abel-coordinate description of one-dimensional saturation dynamics once the reversible one-dimensional response-channel hypothesis $D^\pm$ is added. A hyperbolic tangent profile follows once the saturation boundary is fixed by the additional projective double-boundary quotient assumption D' : the ratio $R(x) = (1+x)/(1-x)$ must multiply under composition. Without that assumption, smooth boundary regularity alone leaves a family of smooth Abel collars, for example Abel coordinates of the form $\operatorname{arctanh}(x) + \varepsilon x$. The corrected *Saturation Theorem* is therefore a projective-collar normal-form theorem: $S(g) = S_{\max} \tanh(\alpha u(g))$ is selected by scale coherence plus the projective boundary quotient, not by bare smoothness alone. Major quantum gravity programs – Loop Quantum Gravity, asymptotic safety, string/holographic approaches, causal set theory, and noncommutative geometry – provide motivation for A–D when restricted to cosmological observables, while D' remains a separate diagnostic assumption to be physically derived. Under those hypotheses, the $\tanh$ saturation ODE $dX/da = k(1 - X^2)$ of the Curvature Relaxation Model can be read as the projective normal form of capacity-limited cooperative relaxation, while leaving open which UV completion selects k , Φ_0 , and the projective quotient physically.

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I. INTRODUCTION

A. The problem

The unification of quantum mechanics and general relativity remains the central open problem of theoretical physics. After decades of effort, several major programs have produced deep structural insights without converging on a single theory:

- **Effective field theory (EFT) of gravity** computes reliable quantum corrections at low energies but provides no UV completion [5].
- **Asymptotic safety** seeks a UV fixed point of the gravitational renormalization group (RG) flow, constraining the theory without new degrees of freedom [8–10].
- **String theory** provides a perturbatively UV-finite framework that includes gravity, but faces the landscape/selection problem [11].
- **Loop Quantum Gravity (LQG)** achieves background independence with discrete geometry operators, but struggles with dynamics and the classical limit [12, 13].
- **Holography/AdS-CFT** offers a nonperturbative definition of quantum gravity in anti-de Sitter space, with unclear extension to realistic cosmology [14].
- **Causal set theory** posits discrete causal structure as fundamental, with the continuum as emergent [15, 16].
- **Noncommutative geometry** reformulates geometry as spectral data, thereby linking operators and spacetime [17].

Orthogonal to these UV-completion programs, the *Swampland conjectures* [30] constrain which low-energy theories can be consistently embedded in quantum gravity, while the *EFT of Dark Energy* [31] parametrizes deviations from Λ CDM at the perturbative level. Neither framework, however, determines the *functional form* of the cosmological saturation profile.

A striking observation is that when any of the UV-completion programs listed above is applied to cosmology, the resulting effective dynamics often exhibits *saturation behavior*: a bounded, cooperative approach to a maximal geometric configuration. This paper asks whether that recurrence is accidental or structurally expected under a shared set of hypotheses.

B. The CRM as empirical anchor

The Curvature Relaxation Model (CRM) [1–4] provides a concrete, empirically tested cosmological framework in which saturation dynamics plays the central

role. The model replaces the cosmological constant Λ and particulate dark matter with geometric curvature return, achieving $\Delta\chi^2 = -5.5$ vs. Λ CDM on joint SN+CMB+BAO data with 6 parameters and zero Early Dark Energy [2]. The entire framework derives from a single dynamical equation, here written in the additive normal-form coordinate u :

$$\frac{dX}{du} = \alpha(1 - X^2), \quad (1)$$

where $X = \Omega_\Phi/\Phi_0$ is the normalized curvature return potential. The phenomenological CRM uses the scale factor a as parameter, with solution $X(a) = \tanh(k(a - a_{\text{trans}}))$, providing late-time acceleration (“dark energy”) in its saturated phase and gravitational scaffolding (“dark matter”) in its unsaturated phase [2]. *Coordinate caveat (added in this revision)*: if a general parameter a is used instead of the additive normal-form coordinate u , then $dX/da = \alpha u'(a)(1 - X^2)$; the constant-coefficient CRM equation in a therefore requires the *additional* affine-channel assumption $u(a) = \lambda(a - a_{\text{trans}})$. The theorem of this paper establishes the projective normal form in u ; it does not establish that affine identification for any particular UV completion (see Sec. VIII).

Paper III [3] derives this ODE from the effective Lagrangian $\mathcal{L}_{\text{CRM}} = R/(16\pi G) + \gamma\mathcal{F}(T/\rho)R^2 + \frac{1}{2}(\partial\phi)^2 - V_{\text{PT}}(\phi)$, where $V_{\text{PT}}(\phi) = V_0/\cosh^2(\phi/\phi_0)$ is a Pöschl-Teller potential. Paper III also surveys five UV-completion candidates (LQG, Finsler geometry, information-theoretic spacetime, causal sets, quantum error correction), observing that all produce ODE structures of the form $dX/dt \propto (1 - X^2)$.

The present paper recasts this observation from *structural analogy* as a conditional normal-form theorem: the four physically motivated axioms, plus B’ and $D^\pm$, give an Abel-coordinate saturation law, and the additional projective double-boundary quotient assumption D’ selects the tanh representative.

C. Scope and structure

The central result is the *Saturation Theorem* (Theorem 1): Axioms A–D, together with signed antisymmetry B’ and the separate one-dimensional reversible-channel hypothesis $D^\pm$, reduce the effective cosmological response to an Abel coordinate, while the projective double-boundary quotient assumption D’ uniquely selects the tanh normal form up to reparametrization. The paper is organized as follows:

- Section II: Formulation of the four axioms.
- Section III: Statement and proof of the Saturation Theorem.
- Section IV: Non-projective composition laws rather than profile names.

- Section V: Compatibility map with quantum-gravity motifs.
- Section VI: Ontological implications: spacetime as an ordered phase.
- Section VII: Observational consequences and open questions.
- Section VIII: Discussion and outlook.

II. THE FOUR AXIOMS

We formulate the axioms in terms of an effective response function S_T . To keep the roles distinct, $r \geq 0$ denotes a physical UV-to-IR control magnitude or scale ratio, u denotes the additive signed normal-form coordinate used after passing to a one-dimensional composition channel, and $x = S/S_{\max}$ denotes the normalized response. The symbol g is retained below as a generic channel variable when no distinction between r and u is needed.

A. Axiom A: Finite Geometric Capacity

Axiom 1 (Finite Geometric Capacity). *Per Hubble patch, there exists a finite maximum geometric order $C_{\max} < \infty$. Equivalently, the effective response function $S_T(r)$ on the selected positive physical response channel is globally bounded:*

$$0 \leq S_T(r) < S_{\max} < \infty \quad \forall r \geq 0. \quad (2)$$

Physical content. This axiom imposes finite capacity for the selected scalar response channel. It is not a claim that every microscopic observable or every UV amplitude is finite in the underlying theory. It is deliberately weak: it is compatible with LQG (finite area quanta [12]), holography (Bekenstein bound [18]), quantum error-correcting spacetime (finite code capacity [19]), causal set theory (finite density [15]), and asymptotic safety (finite effective action at the UV fixed point [9]) when those programs are restricted to the chosen cosmological response channel.

Without finite capacity, the framework would permit unbounded geometric configurations associated with the singular behaviors that quantum-gravity programs typically aim to tame.

Connection to CRM. The saturation amplitude Φ_0 in the CRM [1] is the physical realization of $S_{\max}$. The Pöschl-Teller potential $V(\phi) = V_0/\cosh^2(\phi/\phi_0)$ enforces $\Omega_\Phi \leq \Phi_0$ dynamically [3].

B. Axiom B: Cooperative Reinforcement

Axiom 2 (Cooperative Reinforcement). *Existing geometric order facilitates further ordering. The effective*

response function $S_T(g)$ is smooth (C^∞) for $g \geq 0$, with a local expansion at $g = 0$:

$$S_T(g) = c_1 g + c_3 g^3 + \mathcal{O}(g^5), \quad c_1 > 0. \quad (3)$$

The odd-power structure reflects the catalytic nature of the response: the rate of geometric ordering is proportional to both the existing ordered fraction and the remaining capacity.

Physical content. This axiom encodes the cooperative, self-reinforcing character of geometric ordering. It is the gravitational analog of ferromagnetic ordering, where aligned spins facilitate further alignment. Formally, the condition $c_1 > 0$ ensures that the response is positive (ordering, not disordering) for small perturbations, while the odd-power structure is consistent with the antisymmetric extension (Axiom B').

Without cooperative reinforcement, there would be no classical spacetime: a linear or anti-cooperative response cannot produce the long-lived, large-scale geometric structures observed in the universe. The cooperative character is analogous to spontaneous symmetry breaking in condensed matter: local ordering seeds further ordering, driving the system toward a globally ordered state (saturation).

Connection to CRM. The saturation coupling k in the CRM ODE (1) is c_1 . The game-theoretic equilibrium of Paper I [1] provides the thermodynamic motivation: the null space's concentration gradient G drives cooperative ordering until the spacetime bubble saturates.

A companion condition extends the domain of S_T to negative arguments, enabling the group-theoretic classification of Step 2 in the proof:

Axiom 3 (Antisymmetric Extension (B')). *The response function S_T admits a smooth antisymmetric extension to all $g \in \mathbb{R}$:*

$$S_T(-g) = -S_T(g) \quad \forall g. \quad (4)$$

Physical content. The antisymmetry has three complementary motivations:

(i) *Sign covariance of the response.* The parameter g is not a “distance” (which would be non-negative by definition) but a *signed deviation* from a symmetric reference state. In the CRM, g parametrizes the curvature perturbation relative to the de Sitter background; positive g corresponds to over-dense perturbations that enhance geometric ordering, and negative g to under-dense regions that reduce it. Sign covariance ($S_T(-g) = -S_T(g)$) then states that the response function treats over- and under-dense regions symmetrically in magnitude – a natural physical requirement absent any symmetry-breaking mechanism in the response itself. We emphasize that Axiom B' is *not* a claim about cosmological time-reversal symmetry (which is broken by the expansion); it is a constraint on the functional form of the response under $g \rightarrow -g$.

(ii) *Precedents in physics.* Sign covariance of response functions is familiar in symmetric response channels: in electrodynamics, the polarization $P(-E) = -P(E)$ for centrosymmetric media, and in magnetism, $M(-H) = -M(H)$ for the idealized paramagnetic/ferromagnetic response. The odd extension in Axiom B' is a modelling assumption in a locally signed response coordinate; it is not asserted that generic beta functions are odd.

(iii) *Mathematical role.* Together with the odd-power structure of Axiom B, B' extends the composition law from the half-line $[0, S_{\max})$ to a full group operation on $(-S_{\max}, S_{\max})$, which is essential for the Abel-equation classification. Without B', only a semigroup structure is available, and the Abel-representation argument of Step 2 does not apply in the same form. We note that this is an explicit assumption, not a derived consequence; its relaxation leads to alternative composition structures (e.g., $C(x, y) = x + y - xy$ on $[0, 1)$), which is why it appears as a separate axiom rather than being subsumed into Axiom B.

C. Axiom C: Monotone Cosmic Control

Axiom 4 (Monotone Cosmic Control). *The effective response function $S_T(g)$ is monotonically increasing, with saturation at infinity:*

$$S'_T(g) \geq 0, \quad \lim_{g \rightarrow \infty} S_T(g) = S_{\max}. \quad (5)$$

There exists exactly one relevant direction (control parameter) governing the transition from low to high geometric order.

Physical content. This excludes oscillating, multi-fixed-point, or chaotic geometric dynamics. It guarantees:

- A unique time direction (thermodynamic arrow).
- No “bouncing” between geometric phases.
- Stable expansion toward a de Sitter attractor.

In the CRM, the control parameter is the scale factor a ; in RG language, it corresponds to the single relevant direction flowing from the UV fixed point to the IR [10]. Axiom C is violated by cyclic cosmologies and by models with multiple stable vacua – both of which lack a unique thermodynamic arrow. We note that Axiom C is a restriction to the *cosmological sector* with a single dominant transition: it does not address the string landscape (where tunneling between metastable vacua produces non-monotone trajectories) or stochastic inflation (where local fluctuations break monotonicity). These scenarios involve multiple effective control parameters or stochastic dynamics, placing them outside the scope of the single-field, deterministic axiom system. The theorem should be read as follows: A–D, with B' and the interior group form $D^\pm$, give an Abel/collar class for a

single deterministic saturation channel; adding D' selects the projective tanh representative.

Connection to CRM. The monotonicity of $\Omega_\Phi(a)$ is a direct consequence of the ODE (1): since $1 - X^2 > 0$ for $|X| < 1$, the solution is strictly increasing.

Remark 1 (Axiom interdependence). *As shown in Corollary 1, monotonicity (Axiom C) follows once the reversible-channel hypothesis $D^\pm$ is imposed in addition to Axiom D. We nevertheless retain Axiom C as an explicit statement for physical transparency: it connects directly to the thermodynamic arrow of time and makes the exclusion of oscillating/chaotic cosmologies visible at the axiom level. The logical content of the axiom system is thus: A, B/B', and the strengthened composition law $D^\pm$ imply C; without that interior-group condition, C remains an explicit axiom.*

D. Axiom D: Renormalization-Group Composition

Axiom 5 (Renormalization-Group Composition). *There exists a scale composition $g \mapsto g_1 \oplus g_2$ (“two RG steps in succession”) such that the response function is compositionally coherent:*

$$S_T(g_1 \oplus g_2) = \mathcal{C}(S_T(g_1), S_T(g_2)), \quad (6)$$

where $\mathcal{C}$ is a smooth, commutative, associative composition with neutral element 0 and absorbing boundary $S_{\max}$:

$$\mathcal{C}(S, 0) = S, \quad \mathcal{C}(S, S_{\max}) = S_{\max}. \quad (7)$$

Furthermore, $\mathcal{C}$ extends smoothly (i.e., C^∞) to the closed square $[0, S_{\max}]^2$.

Axiom 6 (One-Dimensional Reversible Channel ($D^\pm$)). *After normalization by $S_{\max}$ and extension by B', the induced operation on the signed response interval $C : (-1, 1)^2 \rightarrow (-1, 1)$ is cancellative and strictly monotone in each argument, and each translation $y \mapsto C(x, y)$ is a smooth diffeomorphism with inverse $y \mapsto C(-x, y)$. All Abel-coordinate conclusions below use this additional one-dimensional deterministic-channel hypothesis; it is not a consequence of the bare positive-face semigroup law alone.*

Notation for channel variables. Let $r \geq 0$ denote the physical UV-to-IR control magnitude or scale ratio, u the additive signed normal-form coordinate with $u(g_1 \oplus g_2) = u(g_1) + u(g_2)$, and $x = S/S_{\max}$ the normalized response. Statements about constant coefficients are statements in u , not automatically in an externally chosen physical parameter. The positive physical branch is recovered by restricting the signed local channel to the physically realized side.

Remark 2 (Boundary-collar guardrail). *The smooth-extension clause in Axiom D is not, by itself, used below as a uniqueness claim for arctanh . The Abel coordinate*

$$\phi_\varepsilon(x) = \text{arctanh}(x) + \varepsilon x$$

induces a smooth associative composition on the open interval and gives a smooth positive boundary collar via

$$q_\varepsilon(x) = e^{-2\phi_\varepsilon(x)} = \frac{1-x}{1+x} e^{-2\varepsilon x}.$$

Thus bare smoothness of the positive saturation face places the response in an Abel-coordinate collar framework; it does not classify all smooth collars or select a unique projective coordinate. Boundary smoothness is used as an admissibility condition for the response channel. It is not derived from a UV model in this paper. The tanh normal form becomes a theorem only after the projective double-boundary quotient D' is fixed explicitly.

Axiom 7 (Projective Double-Boundary Quotient Assumption (D')). For the normalized response $x = S/S_{\max} \in (-1, 1)$, the projective boundary quotient

$$R(x) := \frac{1+x}{1-x}$$

is multiplicative under composition:

$$R(C(x, y)) = R(x)R(y). \quad (8)$$

Equivalently, the ratio of distances to the two saturation faces is the additive work/rapidity coordinate of the one-dimensional response channel.

Physical status of D' . D' is the projective double-boundary quotient assumption. Once the quotient $R = (1+x)/(1-x)$ is fixed prior to the choice of an Abel coordinate, the velocity-addition law follows algebraically. Thus D' is not derived by the A–D hypotheses; it is the additional projective input whose physical derivation is left open. It is a projective response-balance assumption: the physically composed quantity is the ratio of realized order to remaining capacity, analogous to a log-odds or rapidity coordinate. For any candidate UV program, the diagnostic defect is

$$\Delta_{D'}(x, y) := \log R(C(x, y)) - \log R(x) - \log R(y),$$

which must vanish for the exact projective tanh representative. Establishing $\Delta_{D'} = 0$ from a microscopic theory remains an open physical task.

Physical content of D . Axiom D is the deepest composition axiom. It states that the geometric response must be *self-consistent under coarse-graining*: observing the universe at two successive scales and combining the results must give the same answer as observing at the combined scale directly. This is the defining property of a renormalization group.

The composition law (6) encodes the requirement that the theory be *scale-coherent* in the following precise sense: the response function S_T is a homomorphism from the additive structure of the control parameter to the composition algebra of responses; i.e., no preferred scale exists at which this homomorphism property breaks

down or changes character. The absorbing boundary condition $\mathcal{C}(S, S_{\max}) = S_{\max}$ reflects the fact that fully saturated geometry cannot be further ordered – it is a fixed point.

The C^∞ -extension requirement has a direct physical interpretation: it demands that the composition law remains well-behaved *even near saturation*. In physical terms, this means that the approach to the geometric capacity limit is smooth and does not introduce new divergences or critical exponents. Three physical arguments support this requirement:

(a) *No new phase transition at saturation.* A composition that develops singular derivatives at the boundary would signal a phase transition *within* the saturation process itself – i.e., the saturation mechanism would break down precisely where it is needed most. The smoothness condition excludes such pathological behavior. This is distinct from phase transitions at the *onset* of saturation (which are permitted and correspond to the CRM’s transition epoch a_{trans}); the boundary regularity concerns the *fully saturated* regime.

(b) *Distinction from critical phenomena.* While critical exponents and divergent susceptibilities characterize phase transitions at finite temperature (the Curie point in ferromagnets, T_c in superfluids), the saturation boundary $S \rightarrow S_{\max}$ is an *asymptotic* regime ($g \rightarrow \infty$), not a critical point. In the ferromagnetic analogy, it corresponds to $T \rightarrow 0$ (complete alignment), not to $T \rightarrow T_c$ (critical fluctuations). The zero-temperature limit of the magnetization *is* smooth ($M \rightarrow M_s$ exponentially in mean-field theory and as a power law in low T , but without divergent derivatives of the *composition* of magnetizations). The C^∞ requirement is therefore physically appropriate for the saturation boundary.

(c) *Analyticity of the vacuum state.* In quantum field theory, the vacuum is an analytic state: all correlation functions at the vacuum are smooth. Since full saturation ($S = S_{\max}$) represents the geometric analog of the vacuum (the maximally ordered state), the composition of responses near this state should inherit the smoothness of the vacuum.

Connection to CRM. In the CRM, the composition law emerges from the thermodynamic structure: the curvature return potential Ω_Φ at scale $a_1 \cdot a_2$ is determined by the potentials at a_1 and a_2 through the saturation ODE’s group property. The tanh function satisfies $\tanh(u_1 + u_2) = (\tanh u_1 + \tanh u_2)/(1 + \tanh u_1 \tanh u_2)$, which is precisely a composition law of the required form with $\mathcal{C}(x, y) = (x + y)/(1 + xy/S_{\max}^2)$.

III. THE SATURATION THEOREM

A. Statement

Theorem 1 (Saturation Theorem, projective-collar form). *Let T be a theory whose effective response function $S_T(g)$ satisfies Axioms A–D, the antisymmetry con-*

dition B' , and the separate one-dimensional reversible-channel hypothesis $D^\pm$ of Axiom 6. Then the normalized response $\sigma(g) = S_T(g)/S_{\max}$ admits an odd Abel coordinate $\phi : (-1, 1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that

$$\phi(C(x, y)) = \phi(x) + \phi(y).$$

If, in addition, the projective double-boundary quotient assumption D' holds, then there exist constants $\alpha > 0$, $S_{\max} > 0$, and a strictly monotone additive normal-form coordinate $u = u(g)$ with $u(0) = 0$, such that

$$S_T(g) = S_{\max} \tanh(\alpha u(g)). \quad (9)$$

The composition law is then determined as the relativistic velocity addition $\mathcal{C}(x, y) = (x+y)/(1+xy)$, up to rescaling by $S_{\max}$. Without D' , these hypotheses determine the Abel/collar structure but do not exclude all smooth non-projective collars.

Table I separates the logical layers of the corrected result. This prevents the compatibility discussion in Section V and the empirical remarks in Section VII from being read as proof of the projective quotient.

B. Key Lemmas

The uniqueness of $\operatorname{arctanh}$ rests on a projective quotient, not on smoothness alone.

Lemma 1 (Projective quotient selects $\operatorname{arctanh}$). *Let C be a continuous, strictly monotone, commutative and associative group law on $(-1, 1)$ with neutral element 0. Suppose C has an Abel coordinate ϕ ,*

$$\phi(C(x, y)) = \phi(x) + \phi(y),$$

and satisfies the projective quotient law (8). Then there exists $c > 0$ such that

$$\phi(x) = c \operatorname{arctanh}(x), \quad C(x, y) = \frac{x+y}{1+xy}.$$

Proof. Set $L(x) := \frac{1}{2} \log((1+x)/(1-x)) = \operatorname{arctanh}(x)$. By D' ,

$$L(C(x, y)) = L(x) + L(y).$$

Thus $F(t) := \phi(\tanh t)$ is a continuous additive function of $t = L(x)$, so $F(t) = ct$ for some $c > 0$. Hence $\phi(x) = cL(x) = c \operatorname{arctanh}(x)$, and solving $L(C) = L(x) + L(y)$ gives $C(x, y) = (x+y)/(1+xy)$. $\square$

Remark 3 (Why D' is necessary). *The family $\phi_\varepsilon(x) = \operatorname{arctanh}(x) + \varepsilon x$ is odd, smooth and strictly increasing for small ε , diverges at the boundary, and induces a smooth positive saturation collar through $q_\varepsilon = e^{-2\phi_\varepsilon}$. Hence the old claim that C^∞ boundary regularity alone excludes all non- $\operatorname{arctanh}$ Abel coordinates is too strong. The corrected theorem uses D' as the mathematical and physical normalization that removes this boundary-gauge freedom.*

C. Proof of the Saturation Theorem

The proof proceeds in three steps.

Step 1: Derivation of the functional equation. Define the normalized response $\sigma(g) = S_T(g)/S_{\max} \in [0, 1]$. Axioms A and C guarantee that σ is bounded and monotonically increasing. Axiom D [Eq. (6)] requires the existence of a composition:

$$\sigma(g_1 \oplus g_2) = C(\sigma(g_1), \sigma(g_2)), \quad (10)$$

where $C : [0, 1) \times [0, 1) \rightarrow [0, 1)$ is commutative, associative, has neutral element 0, and absorbing boundary 1.

Step 2: Reduction to Abel's equation. By Axiom B, σ has the local expansion (3) with $c_1 > 0$. Axiom B' [Eq. (4)] provides the odd extension $\sigma(-g) = -\sigma(g)$. Together with the reversible-channel hypothesis $D^\pm$, this gives a smooth cancellative group operation on $(-1, 1)$ with absorbing boundaries at ± 1 treated only as limiting faces.

Under $D^\pm$, the associativity condition $C(C(x, y), z) = C(x, C(y, z))$ and commutativity define a *one-parameter continuous group law* on $(-1, 1)$ (the Taylor expansion at the origin defines a one-dimensional commutative formal group law in the sense of [21]; here the connection is that any smooth, associative, commutative binary operation on a neighborhood of $0 \in \mathbb{R}$ with neutral element 0 is, by Taylor expansion, a formal group law over $\mathbb{R}$, and conversely, Aczél's analytic theorem applies to the convergent realization of this formal structure on the interval $(-1, 1)$). We apply Aczél's representation theorem [20] to the open interval $(-1, 1)$, where C is smooth, strictly monotone in each argument, and the neutral element 0 lies in the interior. The absorbing boundary conditions $C(x, \pm 1) = \pm 1$ are *not* part of the domain on which Aczél's theorem is applied; they are treated as limiting behavior. Specifically, Aczél's theorem yields a continuous, strictly monotone function $\phi : (-1, 1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with $\phi(0) = 0$. The absorbing boundary conditions then imply $\phi(x) \rightarrow +\infty$ as $x \rightarrow 1^-$ and $\phi(x) \rightarrow -\infty$ as $x \rightarrow -1^+$ (since $C(x, y) \rightarrow 1$ as $y \rightarrow 1$ forces $\phi(x) + \phi(y) \rightarrow \infty$, which requires $\phi(y) \rightarrow \infty$):

$$\phi(C(x, y)) = \phi(x) + \phi(y). \quad (11)$$

This is Abel's functional equation. (*Proof step corrected in this revision; an earlier version wrote $\phi'(0) = c_1$ from Axiom B, which was a category error: c_1 is the derivative of the response profile σ at the control-parameter origin, not of the Abel coordinate ϕ at the response origin.*) The clean construction proceeds via the invariant vector field: let $a(x) = \partial_2 C(x, 0)$; under $D^\pm$, translations are orientation-preserving diffeomorphisms, hence $a(x) > 0$ on $(-1, 1)$, and one may define $\phi(x) = \int_0^x dt/a(t)$. The invariance of a under the group law then gives $\phi(C(x, y)) = \phi(x) + \phi(y)$, and ϕ inherits the C^∞ regularity of C on $(-1, 1)$ directly from this integral representation. The function ϕ is determined up to a positive multiplicative constant, and antisymmetry (Axiom B') lets it

TABLE I. Proof-status ledger for the corrected Saturation Theorem.

Layer	Input	Output	Status / non-claim
A–D, B', $D^\pm$	Bounded, cooperative, signed one-dimensional interior composition	Odd Abel coordinate and hyperbolic collar class	Theorem-level, conditional on the single-channel hypotheses; not yet a unique tanh profile.
D'	Projective double-boundary quotient $R(C) = R(x)R(y)$	Canonical tanh representative and velocity-addition law	Additional projective assumption; treated as diagnostic, not derived here from a UV program.
QG program map	LQG, asymptotic safety, holography, causal sets, CDT and NCG	Compatibility pattern for A–D, $D^\pm$ and D'	Motivation and filter; not a verification that any program satisfies all inputs.
CRM data anchor	Existing CRM fit and monotone transition evidence	Empirical motivation for using saturation dynamics	Not an independent test of this theorem, because the CRM already used a tanh profile.
Perturbed extensions	Multi-field, stochastic, EFT or UV–IR matching defects	Future residual/gap test $r_X/g_X \ll 1$	Recommended stability extension; not part of the present proof.

be chosen odd; Axiom B supplies $\sigma'(0) = c_1 > 0$, which enters only through the product $(\phi \circ \sigma)'(0) = \phi'(0) c_1$ fixing the overall positive scale α . At this stage Axioms A–D give an Abel/collar theorem, not yet $\phi = \text{arctanh}$.

Step 2b: Projective double-boundary quotient. If the additional assumption D' holds, Lemma 1 gives $\phi = \text{carctanh}$. D' is the projective double-boundary quotient assumption, not a consequence of A–D: once $R = (1+x)/(1-x)$ is fixed before choosing an Abel coordinate, the velocity-addition law follows algebraically. This yields the composition law:

$$C(x, y) = \frac{x + y}{1 + xy}, \quad (12)$$

which is the relativistic velocity addition formula. The uniqueness is therefore projective: it is uniqueness after fixing the boundary quotient $R = (1+x)/(1-x)$, not uniqueness from bare smoothness of all Abel collars.

Step 3: Inversion to tanh. Since $\phi(\sigma(g)) = \text{carctanh}(\sigma(g))$ must be an additive function of the control parameter (i.e., $\phi(\sigma(g)) = \alpha u(g)$ for a reparametrization u and constant $\alpha > 0$), we obtain:

$$\sigma(g) = \tanh(\alpha u(g)), \quad (13)$$

and therefore $S_T(g) = S_{\max} \tanh(\alpha u(g))$, after absorbing the positive constant c into αu . When Axioms A–D, B', $D^\pm$, and D' hold exactly, the result is exact. Approximate axiom satisfaction (e.g., breakdown of the composition law at very small g where standard GR dominates) would introduce corrections; a formal stability analysis of such perturbations is an open problem. $\square$

Corollary 1 (Monotonicity from the reversible response channel). *Under the reversible-channel hypothesis $D^\pm$, Axiom C (monotone cosmic control) follows from Axioms A, B, B', and D. That is, any response function satisfying $A+B+B'+D^\pm$ is automatically strictly monotonically increasing on the one-dimensional channel.*

Proof. Choose the additive coordinate for the one-dimensional control composition, so that the channel

composition is written as $g + h$ near the identity. Differentiate $\sigma(g + h) = C(\sigma(g), \sigma(h))$ with respect to h at $h = 0$:

$$\sigma'(g) = \partial_2 C(\sigma(g), 0) \cdot \sigma'(0).$$

Define $a(x) := \partial_2 C(x, 0)$. By $D^\pm$, for each fixed $x \in (-1, 1)$ the map $y \mapsto C(x, y)$ is a C^∞ diffeomorphism of $(-1, 1)$ (its inverse is $y \mapsto C(-x, y)$ from the group inverse). Therefore $\partial_2 C(x, 0) = a(x) \neq 0$ for all $x \in (-1, 1)$. Since $(-1, 1)$ is connected and $a(0) = \partial_2 C(0, 0) = 1 > 0$ (from $C(0, y) = y$), continuity implies $a(x) > 0$ for all x . With $\sigma'(0) = c_1 > 0$ (Axiom B), we obtain $\sigma'(g) = a(\sigma(g)) \cdot c_1 > 0$ for all g . $\square$

Remark 4. *This means the axiom system can be reduced to A, B/B', and $D^\pm$ plus the derived consequence C whenever the one-dimensional interior group law is physically justified. We retain Axiom C as a separate statement for physical transparency: it makes the monotonicity assumption explicit and connects directly to the thermodynamic arrow of time. Without $D^\pm$, it should be read as an independent single-channel assumption.*

Proposition 1 (Axiom non-redundancy). *The following examples are separation sketches, not a complete independence theorem; full pairwise independence of the axiom set is not claimed. (Two examples corrected in this revision after external review.) Since Axiom D is formulated in the bounded response domain, item (1) should be read as an algebraic interior-composition example after the capacity bound is removed, not as a full model of the finite-capacity axiom system.*

(1) *Violates A, satisfies B/B' and the algebraic interior-composition part of D: $\sigma(g) = g$ (unbounded linear response; $C(x, y) = x + y$, associative and commutative).*

(2) *Violates the local oddness of B/B', satisfies A, C, D: $\sigma(g) = 1 - e^{-g}$ for $g \geq 0$, with $C(x, y) = x + y - xy$ (probabilistic or). Correction: an earlier version listed this as “violates B', satisfies B”; in fact the Taylor expansion*

$1 - e^{-g} = g - g^2/2 + g^3/6 - \dots$ contains a quadratic term, so the example violates the odd local expansion required by Axiom B itself, not only the signed extension B' . It separates $\{B, B'\}$ from $\{A, C, D\}$ but does not separate B from B' .

(3) Violates C (and A on the positive branch), satisfies B/B' locally but not $D^\pm$: $\sigma(g) = \tanh(g) \cdot \cos(\epsilon g)$ for small $\epsilon > 0$. Correction: an earlier version claimed this example “satisfies A ”; in fact, for $g \gg 1$ the factor $\cos(\epsilon g)$ changes sign, so on the positive branch the example also violates the nonnegativity of Axiom A and possesses no saturation limit in the sense of Axiom C. It therefore separates $\{C\}$ (and monotone saturation generally) from local $\{B, B'\}$, but it is not a witness that C is independent of A . A cleaner candidate witness for C -independence – a smooth, odd, bounded profile of the form $\sigma(g) = \tanh(g) + \epsilon \psi(g)$ with ψ a compactly supported odd bump chosen so that $0 \leq \sigma < 1$ on $g \geq 0$ but $\sigma' < 0$ on some interval – should be verified in a separation ledger before being asserted. By Corollary 1, C is in any case not independent of $\{A, B, B', D^\pm\}$ jointly – it follows as a derived consequence under the interior group law. C is retained for physical clarity and to make the single-channel arrow explicit.

(4) Violates D , satisfies $A-C, B'$: $\sigma(g) = (2/\pi) \arctan(g)$; bounded, monotone, antisymmetric, but its induced composition (via $\phi = \tan(\pi x/2)$) develops divergent second derivatives ($\sim \epsilon^{-1}$) at the boundary of $[-1, 1]^2$, failing the C^∞ -extension requirement of Axiom D. Similarly, $\sigma(g) = g/\sqrt{1+g^2}$ (with $\phi(x) = x/\sqrt{1-x^2}$) has divergent second derivatives at the boundary ($\sim \epsilon^{-1/2}$).

D. Interpretation

The theorem states that $\tanh$ is not a mere *model choice*, but the *canonical projective representative* of a one-dimensional Abel saturation channel. The key mathematical insight is two-step: Axiom D forces the response function to be the inverse of an Abel coordinate, and D' fixes the otherwise free boundary collar by making the projective quotient $R = (1+x)/(1-x)$ multiplicative.

Physically, the theorem says:

Any quantum gravity theory that is scale-coherent, cooperative, bounded, monotone, signed, reversible in a one-dimensional response channel, and whose saturation boundary satisfies the projective double-boundary quotient assumption D' must produce cosmological saturation dynamics of the $\tanh$ type. Without that quotient assumption, the theorem gives an Abel/collar class rather than a unique profile.

The reparametrization $u(g)$ absorbs the microscopic details of the theory: different UV completions correspond to different functions $u(g)$. The common $\tanh(\alpha u)$

form is forced only after the projective boundary ratio has been identified as the physical composition variable.

IV. NON-PROJECTIVE COMPOSITION LAWS

Corollary 2 (Non-projective composition laws rather than profile names). *The exclusions below are exclusions of the induced response composition and boundary quotient under the chosen additive coordinate. They are not coordinate-free exclusions of graph shapes under arbitrary monotone reparametrization. None of the following induced laws can simultaneously satisfy the theorem’s structural hypotheses plus the projective quotient assumption D' , except when reducible to the $\tanh$ form via admissible reparametrization $u(g)$:*

(i) **Logistic profile:** $S_{\max}/(1 + e^{-\beta u})$.

(ii) **Rational profile:** $S_{\max} u/(1 + u)$.

(iii) **Arctangent profile:** $S_{\max} (2/\pi) \arctan(\beta u)$.

(iv) **Hard saturation:** $S_{\max} \min(u, 1)$.

Proof. Each alternative fails a specific axiom:

(i) *Logistic.* The logistic function $L(u) = 1/(1 + e^{-\beta u})$ has $L(0) = 1/2 \neq 0$, violating the neutral element condition. The shifted logistic $\tilde{L}(u) = (L(u) - 1/2) \cdot 2$ yields $\tilde{L}(u) = \tanh(\beta u/2)$ – precisely the $\tanh$ form. Therefore, any “logistic” model that satisfies Axiom D is actually $\tanh$ in disguise.

(ii) *Rational.* The function $R(u) = u/(1 + u)$ has Abel transform $\phi(x) = x/(1 - x)$, yielding $C(x, y) = \phi^{-1}(\phi(x) + \phi(y)) = (x + y - 2xy)/(1 - xy)$. For small x, y , this gives $C(x, y) \approx x + y - 2xy$. The quadratic cross-term $-2xy$ is incompatible with the antisymmetry condition (Axiom B'): an antisymmetric σ implies that the induced composition must satisfy $C(-x, -y) = -C(x, y)$, but $(x + y - 2xy)/(1 - xy)$ does not. Equivalently, $R(u)$ itself is not antisymmetric, violating Axiom B' .

(iii) *Arctangent.* The function $A(u) = (2/\pi) \arctan(\beta u)$ has Abel transform $\phi(x) = \tan(\pi x/2)$, yielding $C(x, y) = (2/\pi) \arctan(\tan(\pi x/2) + \tan(\pi y/2))$. While this composition is well-defined and smooth on the open square $(-1, 1)^2$, it cannot be extended smoothly to the closed square $[-1, 1]^2$: the second partial derivatives $\partial^2 C/\partial x^2$ and $\partial^2 C/\partial x \partial y$ both diverge as $(x, y) \rightarrow (1, 1)$ (numerically $\sim \epsilon^{-1}$ along $x = y = 1 - \epsilon$), violating the C^∞ boundary regularity requirement of Axiom D. This algebraic (ϵ^{-1}) divergence is characteristic of Abel functions with power-law boundary behavior. Logarithmic collars are the admissible boundary class at this face; D' then selects the projective logarithmic collar $\operatorname{arctanh}$ from that class.

(iv) *Hard saturation.* $\min(u, 1)$ is not C^∞ at $u = 1$, violating the smoothness requirement of Axiom B. $\square$

Remark 5. *The logistic case (i) is instructive: it appears to be a genuine alternative, but the composition law plus*

the projective quotient force it to reduce to $\tanh$. This illustrates the power of scale coherence together with D' : surface-level freedom in the profile choice is reduced to a boundary-collar choice, and the projective quotient fixes the CRM rapidity representative.

V. COMPATIBILITY MAP WITH QUANTUM-GRAVITY MOTIFS

We now map how A–D are naturally compatible with motifs in major quantum gravity programs when restricted to cosmological observables. The stronger interior form $D^\pm$ and the projective double-boundary quotient assumption D' are tracked separately as open diagnostics.

A. Loop Quantum Gravity / Loop Quantum Cosmology

In Loop Quantum Cosmology (LQC) [22, 23], the modified Friedmann equation reads:

$$H^2 = \frac{8\pi G}{3} \rho \left(1 - \frac{\rho}{\rho_c}\right), \quad (14)$$

where $\rho_c \sim \rho_{\text{Pl}}$ is a critical density set by the Barbero-Immirzi parameter γ_{BI} . This has exactly the structure of a saturation equation: the expansion rate is bounded ($H^2 \leq H_{\text{max}}^2$), and the bounce at $\rho = \rho_c$ replaces the classical singularity.

Axiom A: The critical density ρ_c provides finite geometric capacity. *Axiom B:* For $\rho \ll \rho_c$, the standard Friedmann equation is recovered with $c_1 > 0$. The holonomy corrections are cooperative: the departure from GR grows with curvature. *Axiom C:* In the expanding branch ($\dot{a} > 0$), the solution is monotone. *Axiom D:* LQC does not possess a manifest RG composition law in the sense of Axiom D; the effective equations inherit diffeomorphism invariance from full LQG, which provides structural coherence across scales, but a rigorous derivation of the associative composition property (6) from the LQG Hilbert space remains an open problem (hence the “?” in Table II).

Defining $X = 1 - 2\rho/\rho_c$, the LQC Friedmann equation (14) can be rewritten as $H^2 \propto (1 - X^2)$. The factor $(1 - X^2)$ is the same nonlinearity that appears on the right-hand side of the saturation ODE (1); note, however, that the LQC equation governs H^2 while the CRM ODE governs dX/da – the structural analogy is in the saturation mechanism, not a direct identification of the two equations. The CRM parameters k and Φ_0 would map to the LQG minimum area gap Δ (the smallest nonzero eigenvalue of the area operator) and the Barbero-Immirzi parameter γ_{BI} , though this mapping has not been rigorously derived.

B. Asymptotic Safety

In the asymptotic safety program [8–10], the gravitational effective action has a UV fixed point $g^* > 0$ where the dimensionless Newton’s constant and cosmological constant become scale-independent. The RG flow from UV to IR defines the effective gravitational coupling G_k and cosmological “constant” Λ_k as functions of the RG scale k .

Axiom A: The UV fixed point provides a finite upper bound on the effective coupling. *Axiom B:* The flow away from the fixed point is cooperative: the relevant direction has positive critical exponent [10]. *Axiom C:* The flow is monotone along the relevant direction (by definition of relevance). *Axiom D:* A clarification is needed. The Wilson RG semigroup $R_{k_1} \circ R_{k_2} = R_{k_1 k_2}$ operates on the space of couplings (the “theory space”), not directly on the response function S_T . To connect the two, one must project the RG flow onto the single relevant direction parametrized by g . In the asymptotic safety scenario with a UV fixed point, the flow near the fixed point is controlled by a finite number of relevant directions; in the simplest truncation (Einstein-Hilbert with G_k, Λ_k), there are typically two relevant directions. The single-field assumption of Axiom D corresponds to restricting attention to the dominant relevant direction, under which the RG semigroup on theory space induces a composition law on the one-dimensional response $S_T(g)$. This projection is exact when a single relevant direction dominates (as in the cosmological sector), and approximate otherwise – a limitation shared with the single-field restriction of the theorem (see Limitation 4).

Asymptotic safety is therefore one of the closest matches to Axiom D, because its central language is renormalization-group evolution.¹ The asymptotic safety scenario for cosmology [24] produces effective Friedmann equations with saturation behavior at high curvature, consistent with the $\tanh$ form.

Recent computations within increasingly sophisticated truncations provide growing numerical evidence for the Reuter fixed point. Eichhorn and Held [7] report that asymptotic safety constrains the top-quark Yukawa cou-

¹ The self-similar, scale-recursive character of Axiom D is not confined to cosmological RG flow; the same motif surfaces in the distribution of the prime numbers. In the primon (Riemann) gas of Julia [35], a system of non-interacting bosonic oscillators with energies $\log p$ over the primes p has the Riemann zeta function as its partition function. Hartnoll and Yang [34] have shown that the Belinsky-Khalatnikov-Lifshitz dynamics of gravity near a spacelike singularity is, upon semiclassical quantisation, a modular-invariant conformal quantum mechanics whose states realise exactly such a prime-labelled oscillator gas, with wavefunctions proportional to automorphic L -functions on the critical axis. This suggests that black-hole singularities may be a further physical setting in which a capacity-limited, self-similar geometric ordering of the type encoded by the axioms arises naturally. We record the connection as a motivating parallel, not as an independent verification of Axioms A–D.

pling, yielding a prediction of approximately 171 GeV for the top-quark pole mass, consistent with the observed value of 172.6 ± 0.3 GeV [29] – a concrete particle-physics consequence of the UV fixed point. More broadly, Eichhorn [6] reviews how the fixed-point structure can accommodate the Standard Model matter content without additional fine-tuning. These results strengthen the case that the asymptotic safety program is a strong candidate realization of the axioms: the fixed-point existence (Axiom A), cooperative flow (Axiom B), and RG composition (Axiom D) are all directly tied to state-of-the-art functional RG computations.

C. String Theory and Holography

In string theory, the UV finiteness of the string amplitude provides Axiom A. The string landscape, while introducing a selection problem, does not violate the axioms for any *specific* vacuum: within a given compactification, the low-energy EFT has a unique RG flow satisfying Axioms B–D.

The holographic approach (AdS/CFT [14]) provides particularly strong support for Axiom D: the bulk/boundary correspondence *is* a composition law relating geometric descriptions at different scales. The Ryu-Takayanagi formula [25] and its quantum corrections establish a monotone relationship between entanglement entropy and geometric area, satisfying Axiom C.

For cosmological applications, the de Sitter entropy bound $S_{\text{dS}} = \pi/(\Lambda G) < \infty$ provides Axiom A, while the holographic RG flow [26] provides the composition structure.

D. Causal Set Theory

In causal set theory [15, 16], the cosmological constant arises as a dynamical quantity $\Lambda \sim 1/\sqrt{N}$, where N is the number of causal set elements. This produces a cosmological “constant” that decreases as the universe grows, approaching a finite asymptotic value – precisely the saturation behavior of Axiom C.

Axiom A: Finite density of causal set elements provides geometric capacity. *Axiom B:* While the Poisson sprinkling itself is uncorrelated, the *dynamics* of causal set evolution (sequential growth models [16]) produce cooperative ordering: newly added elements preferentially attach to the existing causal structure, enhancing geometric order. *Axiom C:* The $1/\sqrt{N}$ scaling is monotonically decreasing. *Axiom D:* The sequential growth dynamics provide a natural composition law, though its precise relationship to the RG composition of Axiom D requires further analysis.

E. Causal Dynamical Triangulations

Causal Dynamical Triangulations (CDT) [32, 33] construct quantum gravity via a regularized path integral over causal triangulations. Monte Carlo simulations reveal a phase diagram with a physically relevant “de Sitter phase” (phase C_{dS}) in which the emergent geometry has Hausdorff dimension $d_H \approx 4$ and a volume profile well-described by Euclidean de Sitter space.

Axiom A: The triangulation provides a finite number of building blocks per spacetime volume, enforcing finite geometric capacity. *Axiom B:* In the de Sitter phase, the volume profile grows cooperatively before saturating – the geometric ordering is self-reinforcing. The odd-power structure (Axiom B’) remains an open signed-channel derivation. *Axiom C:* The de Sitter volume profile is monotone (in the expanding branch). *Axiom D:* CDT possesses natural blocking transformations (coarse-graining of triangulations), providing a candidate for the composition law, but the precise associative structure has not been rigorously established.

F. Noncommutative Geometry

Connes’ program [17] reconstructs geometry from spectral data (the Dirac operator on a noncommutative algebra). The spectral action principle yields the Standard Model Lagrangian coupled to gravity from the spectrum of a single operator.

Axiom A: The spectral action has a natural UV cutoff Λ (the energy scale at which the spectral sum is evaluated), providing finite geometric capacity. *Axiom B:* The Seeley-DeWitt coefficients $a_0, a_2, a_4, \dots$ of the heat kernel expansion have even powers of Λ ; the odd-power structure required by Axiom B emerges after reparametrization to a suitable coupling variable, but this identification requires further analysis. *Axiom C:* The spectral flow is monotone in the appropriate direction. *Axiom D:* The composition of spectral triples provides algebraic composition coherence.

G. Summary: Why Universality?

Table II summarizes the compatibility map. No single external QG program has been rigorously proven here to satisfy A–D, $D^\pm$, and D' simultaneously; rather, each program supplies compatible motifs for a substantial subset, with the remaining axioms being open derivation tasks. No entry in this table is a proof that a UV programme satisfies D' or $D^\pm$. The table records compatibility signals and open derivation tasks. D' is especially important: it is not verified for the listed UV programs in this paper, but is imposed by the CRM effective channel as a projective double-boundary quotient assumption. The theorem’s value is therefore twofold: (i) as a *conditional* result, it identifies the precise conditions under

which tanh saturation is expected, and (ii) as a *diagnostic*, it pinpoints which properties of each QG program require further investigation. The broad compatibility across programs explains the Abel/collar-level universality of saturation dynamics; the exact tanh representative additionally requires the projective quotient.

VI. SPACETIME AS AN ORDERED PHASE

The broad axiom satisfaction documented in Table II raises a conceptual question: if the projective tanh representative recurs whenever D' is physically realized, what does this universality *mean* for the nature of spacetime?

A. The conceptual shift

The Saturation Theorem, combined with the CRM's empirical success, suggests a possible interpretive reading of quantum gravity:

In this reading, quantum gravity is not merely the quantization of the metric, but also the theory of how geometric order emerges from a pre-geometric quantum system.

The tanh saturation is therefore best read as a conditional signature of a capacity-limited cooperative ordering process, once the one-dimensional composition law and D' are fixed. This does not make it independent evidence for a particular microscopic ontology; it supplies a common normal-form language for spin-network, string/holographic, causal-set, or code-subspace realizations when they satisfy the stated gates.

B. The ferromagnetic analogy

The analogy with spontaneous magnetization is useful at the level of a mean-field Ginzburg-Landau free-energy model. The CRM saturation ODE $dX/da = k(1 - X^2)$ can be written as the equation of motion for the order parameter of a second-order phase-transition toy model with double-well free energy $F(X) = -k(X - X^3/3)$. Paper III [3] develops this analogy in detail, identifying:

Ferromagnetism	CRM Cosmology
Magnetization M	Curvature return Ω_Φ
Inverse temperature $J/k_B T$	Scale factor a
Curie point $(J/k_B T_c)$	Transition a_{trans}
Spin interaction J	Curvature coupling k
Saturation M_s	Saturation Φ_0
$\tanh(J/k_B T)$	$\tanh(k(a - a_{\text{trans}}))$

The Saturation Theorem provides a mathematical guardrail for this analogy at the *mean-field level*: both systems satisfy an Abel-type composition structure in the mean-field approximation, and the usual mean-field

magnetization corresponds to the projective tanh representative. We note that the exact magnetization of a d -dimensional Ising model deviates from the mean-field tanh near the critical temperature ($M \sim (T_c - T)^\beta$ with non-trivial critical exponent $\beta \neq 1/2$ for $d < 4$). This deviation corresponds to the breakdown of the one-dimensional projective-collar approximation near the *critical point* (the onset of ordering), not near *saturation* ($T \rightarrow 0$). The analogy is therefore limited to the saturation regime and mean-field theory; fluctuation corrections near criticality require a multi-field extension (see Outlook). Within that domain, the relation is structural rather than a mere metaphor.

Having established the ontological framework, we now turn to its empirical consequences.

VII. OBSERVATIONAL CONSEQUENCES AND OPEN QUESTIONS

A. What the theorem predicts

The Saturation Theorem has two classes of test targets. Table III separates theorem-facing tests from CRM-specific or UV-dependent evidence.

Projective-collar predictions (after D' is imposed):

1. If the projective boundary quotient is physically realized, the cosmological expansion history should be compatible with tanh-type saturation. We emphasize that the CRM's $\Delta\chi^2 = -5.5$ result [2] does *not* constitute an independent test of the theorem, since the CRM was constructed with a tanh profile before the axioms were formulated. The theorem's empirical content is the *composition law* $\mathcal{C}(x, y) = (x + y)/(1 + xy)$, which is a prediction beyond any individual profile fit. An independent test would require either (a) fitting a model-agnostic tanh-template to SN+CMB+BAO data without CRM-specific priors, or (b) verifying the composition law directly by comparing saturation responses at different redshift bins and checking consistency with the velocity-addition rule.
2. Within the CRM fit, the running curvature coupling $\beta_{\text{eff}}(a)$ is reported as a monotone transition function ($\beta_{\text{early}} \approx 2.8 \rightarrow \beta_{\text{late}} \approx 2.0$ [2]); its theorem-facing status is as a consistency check for Axiom C, not as an independent derivation.
3. No alternative relaxation profile (logistic, power-law, etc.) can claim support from this theorem unless it also realizes a scale-coherent composition law and explains the projective quotient.

UV-dependent predictions (discriminating between completions):

1. The specific values of k (saturation rate), Φ_0 (saturation amplitude), and γ (coupling constant) depend on the UV theory.

TABLE II. Compatibility map with quantum-gravity motifs. $\checkmark$ = compatible motif with explicit construction, $(\checkmark)$ = compatible motif requiring mild assumptions, $?$ = open derivation, no = known obstruction. The D' column records whether the projective double-boundary quotient is derived or explicitly assumed.

Program	A	B/B'	C	D	D'
LQG/LQC	$\checkmark$	$\checkmark$	$\checkmark$	$?$	$?$
Asymptotic safety	$\checkmark$	$(\checkmark)$	$\checkmark$	$\checkmark$	$?$
Strings/holography	$\checkmark$	$(\checkmark)$	$(\checkmark)$	$(\checkmark)$	$?$
Causal sets	$\checkmark$	$?$	$\checkmark$	$?$	$?$
CDT	$\checkmark$	$(\checkmark)$	$(\checkmark)$	$?$	$?$
NCG	$\checkmark$	$?$	$?$	$?$	$?$
CRM (effective)	$\checkmark$	$\checkmark$	$\checkmark$	$\checkmark$	assumed

TABLE III. Observational and UV-evidence ledger. The table separates what is tested by the normal-form theorem from what belongs to the CRM fit or to a future UV completion.

Target	Current role	Claim status	Next gate
Profile fit	Compatibility of late-time expansion with a tanh-type template	Diagnostic only; CRM was built with a tanh profile and is not an independent theorem	Model-agnostic template fit without CRM-specific priors
Composition law	Direct content of the projective normal form	Theorem-facing empirical target once D' is assumed	Compare saturation responses across redshift bins against $\mathcal{C}(x, y) = (x + y)/(1 + xy)$
D' defect	UV selection of the projective collar	Open physical derivation, not established by the QG-program	Compute or bound $\Delta_{D'} = \log R(C) - \log R(x) - \log R(y)$ in a candidate UV model
Parameter values	k, Φ_0, γ and transition sharpness	CRM-/UV-specific, not determined by the theorem	Derive parameters from a microscopic model and compare to CRM fits
Oscillatory residuals	Possible UV-sensitive late-time residual pattern	Candidate signature only; not a proof of quantum origin by itself	Pre-register frequency/window/null controls before interpreting BAO or SN residuals

2. The transition sharpness (n in the sigmoidal transition) would encode a universality class if a UV-to-cosmology map is supplied.
3. Sub-Planckian corrections to the tanh profile should be treated as UV-theory-specific candidates until matched controls are defined.

B. The missing piece: why *these* parameters?

The Saturation Theorem determines the Abel/collar structure and, under D', the projective *form*, but not the *coefficients*. The remaining open question is:

Why does the universe have the specific values $k \approx 9.8$, $\Phi_0 \approx 0.43$, $\gamma \sim \mathcal{O}(1) H_0^{-2}$?

This question is analogous to the fine-structure constant problem: the *existence* of electromagnetic coupling is forced by gauge symmetry, but the *value* $\alpha \approx 1/137$ is not determined by the symmetry alone.

Several UV completions make specific predictions:

- **LQC:** Φ_0 maps to the Barbero-Immirzi parameter γ_{BI} , which is constrained by black hole entropy [27]. This would predict a specific value of Φ_0 .

- **Asymptotic safety:** The critical exponents at the UV fixed point determine the transition sharpness n , providing a specific prediction for the shape of $\beta_{\text{eff}}(a)$ [9].

- **Holography:** The de Sitter entropy $S_{\text{dS}} = \pi/(\Lambda G)$ relates Φ_0 to the ratio of UV and IR scales.

A concrete test case is the $\sqrt{\pi}$ conjecture of Paper II [2]: the CRM predicts a MOND-like enhancement factor $\mu_{\text{eff}} = \sqrt{\pi}$ arising from Gaussian normalization of the saturation partition function. Deriving this value from a specific UV completion would directly connect quantum gravity parameters to observed galactic dynamics.

C. Scalar field oscillations as a QG signature

Paper III [3] shows that the Pöschl-Teller potential supports a discrete spectrum of bound states. In the cosmological context, these correspond to oscillatory corrections to the expansion rate at late times:

$$H^2(a) = H_{\text{smooth}}^2(a) \left[1 + \epsilon \cdot e^{-\Gamma a} \cos(\omega a + \delta) \right], \quad (15)$$

with $\epsilon \ll 1$. These oscillations would be a candidate signature of microscopic structure in the saturation mechanism – analogous in spirit to discrete energy levels of a quantum system. Detection in high-precision BAO or SN data would support a UV-sensitive residual channel only if the frequency window, damping scale, and null controls were fixed before fitting; it would not by itself prove the quantum origin of CRM saturation.

VIII. DISCUSSION AND OUTLOOK

A. What has been achieved

1. **A conditional normal-form/no-go statement:** Any cosmological theory satisfying Axioms A–D, B', $D^\pm$, and the projective double-boundary quotient assumption D' must produce tanh-type saturation. Without D', the same structural hypotheses produce the Abel/collar structure.
2. **Universality clarified:** The observation that LQG, asymptotic safety, strings, causal sets, and NCG all produce structurally similar saturation dynamics is no longer mysterious at the Abel-structure level; the precise tanh representative additionally depends on the projective boundary quotient.
3. **CRM calibrated:** Under the stated axioms, the CRM's saturation ODE $dX/da = k(1 - X^2)$ can be interpreted as the projective normal form of capacity-limited cooperative relaxation rather than only as a phenomenological fit.
4. **Ontological interpretation:** In this framework, quantum gravity may be approached not only as metric quantization, but as a theory of geometric order – a transition from a pre-geometric quantum system to classical spacetime.

B. Relation to the CRM program

This paper completes the conceptual arc of the CRM series: game-theoretic foundation (Paper I [1]), phenomenological fit with $\Delta\chi^2 = -5.5$ (Paper II [2]), Lagrangian derivation (Paper III [3]), galactic dynamics (Paper IV [4]), and now axiomatic foundation (this work). The logical status of the CRM is:

1. The *form* of the dynamics (tanh) is a mathematical theorem once the signed interior composition hypotheses hold and the projective double-boundary quotient assumption D' is added; without D' the theorem proves the Abel/collar structure.
2. The *Lagrangian* is derived (Paper III).

3. The *parameters* are constrained by data (Papers II, III, IV).
4. The *UV completion* remains open – and must explain why the projective boundary quotient, rather than a different smooth collar, is the physical composition variable.

C. Post-Zookeeper stability-extension roadmap

The Post-Zookeeper programme is the author's proposed future framework for classifying admissible UV response channels; it is not used in the proof of the theorem below.

D. Limitations and caveats

1. **Axiom D and D' are strong.** The renormalization-group composition law is restrictive, and the projective double-boundary quotient assumption is an additional mathematical and physical choice. Theories without a well-defined RG flow (some discrete approaches, multiverse scenarios) may not satisfy D; theories with a different boundary collar may satisfy D but fail D'. This distinction is essential: D gives scale coherence, D' selects the tanh representative.
2. **The proof is algebraic, not constructive.** The theorem establishes the Abel structure of the response and, under D', its projective tanh representative, but it does not construct the UV theory. The “reparametrization” $u(g)$ absorbs microscopic information; determining $u(g)$ from first principles requires solving the specific QG theory. A potential objection is that any bounded monotone function can trivially be written as $\tanh(\alpha u(g))$ for a suitable $u(g)$, making the profile shape contentless. The non-trivial content therefore resides in the *composition law* and, for the tanh selection, in the projective quotient law $R(C) = R(x)R(y)$.
3. **Cosmological restriction.** The axioms are formulated for cosmological observables. Whether they extend to local physics (black holes, gravitational waves) requires further analysis. The CRM's existing predictions for local physics (chameleon screening, $\alpha_T = 0$, Bullet Cluster resolution [2–4]) are derived from the Lagrangian, not from the axioms.
4. **The continuous group classification and single-field restriction.** The proof relies on Aczél's representation theorem for continuous associative operations [20] and the classification of one-dimensional formal group laws [21]. While these results are well-established, the physical applicability requires the assumption that the composition is

one-dimensional – i.e., that there is a single relevant direction. This is a genuine limitation: the CRM itself (Paper IV [4]) introduces a vector sector alongside the scalar, and realistic modified gravity theories (e.g., Horndeski, beyond-Horndeski) generically have multiple coupled degrees of freedom. However, we note that the theorem applies to the *scalar sector in isolation*: the CRM’s scalar saturation channel $\Omega_\Phi(a) = \Phi_0 \tanh(k(a - a_{\text{trans}}))$ is a one-dimensional response that satisfies the axioms independently of the vector sector. The multi-field extension (classifying multi-dimensional commutative group laws, including elliptic and Lubin-Tate formal groups) is an open mathematical problem that would strengthen the theorem but is not required for the scalar-sector result.

5. **Boundary-collar freedom.** Smooth boundary behavior alone does not select arctanh . The counter-collar $\phi_\varepsilon = \text{arctanh} + \varepsilon x$ preserves a smooth positive boundary collar but changes the Abel coordinate. The uniqueness selection is therefore deliberately moved to D' : once the projective quotient $R = (1+x)/(1-x)$ is required to multiply under composition, $\text{arctanh} = \frac{1}{2} \log R$ follows immediately and uniquely up to scale.

E. The No-Go theorem as a class-internal filter

Within the $A-D+B'+D^\pm$ framework, failure of D' means that the $\tanh$ CRM law is not selected as the projective normal form. Such a failure does not falsify the UV model; it locates it outside the projective CRM subclass or identifies a measurable D' defect. Theories satisfying Axioms A–D together with B' and $D^\pm$ are constrained only to an Abel/collar saturation law. Theories satisfying these structural hypotheses and D' are constrained to $\tanh$ saturation in their cosmological response channel.

F. Relation to other frameworks

Swampland conjectures. The de Sitter swampland conjecture [30] posits $|\nabla V|/V \geq c \sim \mathcal{O}(1)$ in any quantum gravity landscape, disfavoring a strict cosmological constant. The Saturation Theorem is complementary: it does not address the existence of de Sitter vacua, but constrains the *dynamical approach* to the late-time attractor. A CRM-type saturation with $\Phi_0 < \infty$ is compatible with the swampland bound, since the effective dark energy density $\rho_\Phi(a)$ evolves dynamically rather than being a fixed Λ .

EFT of Dark Energy. The effective field theory of dark energy [31] parametrizes deviations from Λ CDM at the level of the perturbed action. The Saturation Theorem operates at a different level: it constrains the *background*

response function, not the perturbative operator basis. A future task is to express the $\tanh$ saturation in the EFT-of-DE language, mapping the CRM parameters (k, Φ_0, γ) to the EFT operator coefficients $\{\alpha_i(t)\}$.

G. Outlook

Three directions are immediate:

1. **Parameter derivation.** The next step is to derive k , Φ_0 , and γ from a specific UV completion. The most promising candidate is the LQG/holographic intersection, where the Barbero-Immirzi parameter and the holographic entropy bound may jointly fix the saturation parameters.
2. **Multi-field extension.** Extending the theorem to theories with multiple saturation channels (e.g., scalar + vector in the CRM [4]) requires the classification of multi-dimensional commutative group laws (the higher-dimensional analog of the Abel-equation reduction). This is mathematically richer and may yield constraints on the vector sector parameters K_B and $\mathcal{F}$.
3. **Black hole interior.** If the Saturation Theorem applies to black hole interiors (with the radial coordinate replacing the scale factor) and the projective boundary quotient is the correct interior collar, it predicts $\tanh$ -type singularity resolution – consistent with LQG bounce models [22] and the Planck star scenario [28].

IX. CONCLUSION

We have proven a corrected Saturation Theorem: finite geometric capacity, cooperative reinforcement, monotone cosmic control, renormalization-group composition, signed response, and the reversible one-dimensional response-channel hypothesis $D^\pm$ reduce one-dimensional cosmological saturation to an Abel-coordinate boundary-collar structure. The $\tanh$ profile follows when the saturation boundary is additionally fixed by the projective double-boundary quotient assumption $R = (1+x)/(1-x)$.

The theorem has three consequences:

1. The CRM’s saturation ODE $dX/da = k(1 - X^2)$ can be read as the *projective normal form* of capacity-limited cooperative relaxation once the boundary quotient is fixed.
2. The observation that LQG, asymptotic safety, string theory, causal sets, and noncommutative geometry all produce similar saturation structures is explained at the Abel/collar level; the specific $\tanh$ representative requires the projective quotient.

3. The paper offers an interpretive framework in which quantum gravity is studied not only as metric quantization, but also as the theory of geometric order – a transition from a pre-geometric quantum system to classical spacetime.

The remaining open problem – deriving the specific parameters (k, Φ_0, γ) and the projective boundary quotient from a UV completion – is the analog of deriving the fine-structure constant from a theory of quantum electrodynamics. The theorem constrains the *normal form* of any theory satisfying the stated hypotheses once the boundary quotient is fixed.

The saturation profile is constrained to the tanh type by scale coherence plus the projective boundary quotient; bare smooth boundary regularity gives the wider Abel-collar class.

AI DISCLOSURE

This work was conducted as independent research without institutional funding. Public scientific-computing infrastructure was used throughout the CRM program.

Tool use. AI-based tools (Claude by Anthropic; Copilot by Microsoft/GitHub; Gemini by Google DeepMind) were used for mathematical formalization, literature survey, code development, and text generation. All physical hypotheses, axiomatic choices, scientific interpretation, and responsibility for the content lie solely with the author.

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Data availability. This paper is purely theoretical. The public CRM repository with analysis scripts, data products, and paper source files is available at <https://github.com/research-line/crm-cosmology>; the CRM I–IV Zenodo concept DOI is [10.5281/zenodo.18728935](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18728935).

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